

IK 541: Upanishads and Vedanta Studies

Course Code	IK 541
Course Name	Upanishads and Vedanta Studies
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	IK 536 Introduction to Hindu Philosophy or equivalent foundational knowledge in Hindu philosophy
Intended for	BTech/MTech/MS/MSc/MA/Ph.D
Mutual Exclusion	None
Approval	42nd Senate (Jan 2024)

Course Contents

- **Introduction to Upanishads** (5 Hours)
 - Overview and Historical Context
 - Importance and Influence on Hindu Thought
 - Classification and Principal Upanishads
- **Core Teachings of Upanishads** (8 Hours)
 - Concepts of Brahman and Atman Understanding of Māyā (Illusion)
 - The Doctrine of Karma and Rebirth
 - The Nature of Reality: Advaita, Dvaita, and Viśiṣṭādvaita views
- **Deep Dive into Selected Upanishads** (6 Hours)
 - Isha Upanishad: Vision of Oneness
 - Katha Upanishad: Dialogue on Death and Immortality
 - Chāndogya Upanishad: Meditation and Rituals
- **Vedanta Philosophy** (7 Hours)
 - Introduction to Vedānta Darśana
 - Brahma Sūtras and their significance
 - Advaita Vedanta of Ādi Śaṅkarācārya
 - Rāmānuja's Viśiṣṭādvaita
 - Vedanta Madhva's Dvaita Vedanta
- **Contemporary Interpretations** (8 Hours)
 - Modern Vedantic Teachers: Ramaṇa Maharshi, Vivekananda, Aurobindo
 - The Theosophical interpretation of Upanishads and Vedanta Interactions with Western Philosophy and New Age Thought
- **Upanishads, Vedanta, and Daily Life** (4 Hours)
 - Spiritual practices derived from Upanishadic teachings
 - Vedantic approach to modern challenges: Stress, Identity, and Morality
 - Upanishadic view on Ecology and Environment
- **Wrap up and Reflection** (4 Hours)
 - Student presentations on selected topics
 - Group discussions on the application of Upanishadic teachings in contemporary life
 - Closing reflections and the way forward

Text Books

1. Radhakrishnan, S., **The Principal Upanishads**, Harper Collins, 1992.
2. Deussen, P., **Sixty Upanishads of the Veda** (Vol. 1 & 2), Motilal Banarsidass, 2010.

References

1. Vivekananda, S., **Jnana Yoga**, Ramakrishna-Vivekananda Center, 1955.
2. Swami Sivananda, **Upanishads in Story and Dialogue**, Divine Life Society, 2019.
3. Sharma, C., **A Critical Survey of Indian Philosophy**, Motilal Banarasidass Publication, 1964.
4. Easwaran, E., **The Upanishads: A Classic of Indian Spirituality**, Nilgiri Press, 2007.
5. Rukmani, T. S., **A Critical Study of the Bhagavata Purana: With Special Reference to Bhakti**, Chowkhamba Sanskrit Series, 2001.